

If your computer received an FTP request from another computer, `inetd` would use this line to start the FTP program. Comment out this line by putting a hash (#) at the beginning of this line. Similarly look for other entries similar to this one for `telnet`, `finger`, `shell`, `login`, `talk`, `ntalk`, and `auth`. Press [Ctrl] + [X] to exit `pico`. When prompted to save the file, press [Y] and hit [Enter]. You will now need to restart `Inetd` to let the changes take effect. At the command line, type `killall -HUP inetd` to restart `inetd`.

Other Services

There will most likely also be other useless or potentially risky services running on your system apart from those listed in `inetd`. These include `apmd`, `atd`, `netfs`, `httpd`, `portmap`, `pcmcia`, `nfs`, `sendmail`, `routed`, `rstated`, `ruserd`, `rwhod`, and `ybind`. These could allow a savvy Linux hacker to gain access to your system and take over as the system root using some known or currently-undocumented vulnerability in any of these services. The concept is to provide the *minimum footprint for an attack vector*.

You can manually disable these services by renaming the associated program file for each of these services. To do this you would need to know the runlevel of your computer. Linux has six runlevels that load different services at startup. If you are booting into a command line environment, you will usually be at runlevel 3. In a GUI environment, the runlevel is normally 5. To find out your runlevel, type in “runlevel” at the command prompt. This will display the current runlevel of your computer. You will now need to change to the specific runlevel directory to disable the service from starting up at boot.

On Red Hat systems, type in “`cd /etc/rc.d/rc3.d`” (or “`rc5.d`”) depending on whether you are in runlevel 3 or 5.

Type `ls` at the command prompt to list all the files in the directory. If the file name begins with S, it is set to automatically start with the operating system. For example, in the